The passengers held demonstrations in Calcutta but were forced to return to Buj Buj and re-board the ship. When the passengers protested, with some refusing to re-board, police opened fire, killing twenty and wounding nine. Gurdit Singh managed to escape and lived in hiding till 1922. He was persuaded by Mahatma Gandhi to give himself up as a true patriot, which he did, resulting in his imprisonment for five years. 'The return of Komagata Maru passengers (to Punjab) became a cause of concern of the traditional Sikh leadership known for its loyalty to the British Empire. It became increasingly difficult to defend this loyalty. The British administration could not be the guarantor of Sikh interests abroad.' [9]

Addressing the House of Commons in Ottawa on 18 May 2016, Canadian Prime Minister Justin Trudeau formally apologized for the Komagata Maru incident:

> Canada's government was without question responsible for the laws that prevented these passengers from immigrating peacefully and securely. For that, and for every regrettable consequence that followed, we are sorry ... first and foremost, to the victims of the incident. No words can erase the pain and suffering they experienced.
>
> Regrettably, the passage of time means that none are alive to hear our apology today. Still, we offer it, fully and sincerely. For our indifference to your plight. For our failure to recognize all that you had to offer. For the laws that discriminated against you so senselessly. And for not apologizing sooner. For all these things, we are truly sorry.

Trudeau also apologized directly to the passengers' relatives and descendants, some of whom, he noted, were present in the House of Commons' visitors' gallery to hear the apology. 'We can never know what your lives would have been like had your relatives been welcome to Canada... The ways in which your lives would have been different. The ways in which Canada would have been enriched. Those possibilities are lost to history. For that – and to you – we apologize.' He said that Canada must commit itself to positive action, to learning from mistakes, and make sure that the errors of